THARIFITH LANGUAGE COURSE

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Lesson 11

Questions & Interrogatives

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A Comprehensive Guide to Riffian Berber

Mastering the Art of Asking Questions

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1. Introduction to Questions in Tharifith

The ability to ask questions is fundamental to meaningful communication. Questions enable us to seek information, clarify understanding, express interest in others, and navigate social situations. In Tharifith, as in all languages, questions come in various forms, from simple yes/no inquiries to complex questions seeking specific information about people, things, places, times, and reasons. Understanding how questions are formed and used in Tharifith will significantly enhance your communicative competence and allow you to participate more fully in conversations with Riffian speakers.

Tharifith has two main types of questions: yes/no questions, which can be answered with a simple affirmative or negative response, and information questions (also called W H -questions in English), which require specific information in the answer. Yes/no questions in Tharifith are often formed simply through intonation, raising the pitch at the end of a statement, or through the addition of question particles. Information questions require specific question words that correspond roughly to the English 'who,' 'what,' 'where,' 'when,' 'why,' and 'how.' These interrogative words have specific forms in Tharifith that must be learned and practiced.

The cultural context of questioning in Riffian society is also important to understand. Questions are a primary way of showing interest and respect in social interactions, and the ability to ask appropriate questions demonstrates engagement and politeness. However, certain topics may be sensitive, and direct questions about personal matters should be approached with care. Learning to ask questions appropriately in Tharifith involves not only mastering the grammatical forms but also understanding the social conventions that govern their use. This lesson will guide you through both the structural and pragmatic aspects of questioning in Tharifith.

2. Yes/No Questions

Yes/no questions are the simplest type of questions, seeking confirmation or denial of a proposition. In Tharifith, yes/no questions can be formed in several ways: through intonation alone, through the addition of particles, or through word order changes. The most common method is simply to raise the pitch at the end of a statement, much like in English informal speech. However, there are also specific particles that can mark a sentence as a question, and these are particularly useful in writing or when seeking emphasis.

2.1 Intonation Questions

The simplest way to form a yes/no question in Tharifith is to pronounce a statement with rising intonation at the end. This is the most common form in everyday spoken language. The question mark in writing indicates this intonation pattern.

Statement	Question	English
Thrazudh at-echedh	Thrazudh at-echedh ?	do you want to eat?
Netta itett aghrum	Netta itett aghrum?	Is he eating bread?
Agharrabu-yin dh'awragh	Agharrabu-yin dh awragh?	Is that boat yellow ?
Iroh ghar yemmas	Iroh ghar yemmas?	he went to his mother?

2.2 Question Particle « ma »

The particle 'ma' (sometimes switched with 'nigh/nikh') can be placed at the end of a sentence to mark it explicitly as a question. This particle is more common in formal contexts or when seeking a Yes/no answer. It marks an abrupt end of the sentence, but used frequently in tharifith.

Tharifith Question	English
Yedja…ma? / thedja … ma?	Is there? / does it exist?
Netta i-ruḥ ma?	did he go?
ghark tharwa ma?	do you have children?
thzemmar at-ssiwer ma?	can she speak?

2.3 Answering Yes/No Questions:

Yes/no questions can be answered with simple affirmative or negative words. The affirmative answer 'yeh' or 'wah' means 'yes', while 'lla' or 'lawalo' means 'no'. More emphatic responses include 'yedja/ nichan', or 'yedja min teqqadh' (you are right) and 'ur yedji chi/cha min teqqadh' (there isn't/no). The table below shows common ways to answer yes/no questions.

Tharifith	English	Usage
yeh / wah	yes	simple affirmative
Lla /lawalo	no	simple negative
Yedja min teqqadh	What you say is true	confirming existence
ur yedji-chi/cha min teqqadh	What you say is false	denying existence
Dh r'heqq / dh thidhett	It is true	emphatic affirmative
Dh rmohar	probabely not	emphatic negative

2.4 Question and Answer Examples

Question	Answer	English
i-ruḥ ghar spitar?	yeh, i-ruḥ	did he go to the hospital? yes, he went
Thesghidh thisira?	lla, ur sghigh chi/cha	You bought shoes? no, I didn't buy them
Chek ad'ifegh khak uqemum inek/nech?	yeh, dh r'heqq	What you will say will destroy you? It is true
Thezridh yemma?	yeh, ẓright	You saw mom? yes, I saw her
Ad-yekk ssa Morad?	lla, ad yaâdu ghar umedduker ines	will Morad be passing by? no, he will go to his friend

3. Question Words (Interrogatives)

Question words (also called interrogatives) are used to ask for specific information rather than a simple yes or no answer. Tharifith has a rich set of question words that correspond to English 'who,' 'what,' 'where,' 'when,' 'why,' 'how,' and related concepts. These words typically appear at the beginning of the question sentence, though word order can be flexible in Tharifith. Learning these question words is essential for engaging in meaningful conversations and gathering information in Tharifith-speaking environments.

3.1 Basic Question Words

Tharifith	English	Usage
manta / min	what	things, actions
Mani	where	location
Mokh / Mamech	how	manner, condition
Wi / min	who	people
mermi	when	time
Maghar/ maimmi	why	reason
Manecht /mech'har	how much/many	quantity

3.2 Question Words in Context

Tharifith	English
Min i-weqâan?	what happened?
mani i-ruḥ?	where did he go?
mamech thedja?	how is she?
wi dak't innan?	who told you?
mermi gha ad i-as?	when will he come?
Maghar/ maimmi ur dyussi chi/cha?	why didn't he come?
Mech'har yegga ughrum?	how much is the bread?

4. Asking About People

4.1 Identity Questions

Tharifith	English
Min iâna wa?	who is this? (masc)
Min thaâna tha?	who is this? (fem)
Min iâna babas ?	who is his/her father?
Min thaâna yemmas ?	who is his/her mother?

4.2 Asking About Someone's Name

Asking someone's name is a fundamental social skill. There are several ways to ask this question in Tharifith, ranging from formal to informal registers.

Tharifith	English
Min yaâna yisem-inech/inem?	what is your name?
Mokh/mamech dak/dam qaren?	what are you called?

4.3 Asking About Relationships and Family

Tharifith	English
Min yaâna mmik/mmich ?	who is your son?
Min taâna yemmas?	who is his/her mother?
ghar-ch / ghar-m tharwa?	do you have children?
Mech'har iharmuchen i-gharek/gharem?	how many children do you have?

5. Asking About Things and Places

Questions about things and places are essential for navigating daily life. The question words 'min' (what) and 'mani' (where) are used to ask about objects, actions, and locations. These

questions help you identify objects, understand their purpose, find places, and give directions. Mastering these question forms will enable you to shop effectively, find your way in unfamiliar places, and engage in conversations about objects and locations in Tharifith.

5.1 Asking 'What' Questions

Tharifith	English
Min yaâna wa?	what is this? (masc)
Min taâna tha?	what is this? (fem)
Min i-weqâan?	what happened?
Min i-tegg?	what is he doing?
Min gha ad-igg?	what will he do?
Min gharech / gharem?	what do you have?
Min yaâna isem nnes?	what is its name?
Min tegg thamghath-in?	what is that woman doing?

5.2 Asking 'Where' Questions

Tharifith	English
mani yedja?	where is he/it? (masc)
mani thedja?	where is she/it? (fem)
mani i-ruḥ?	where did he go?
mani idja dchar?	where is the village?
mani thedja thaddarth iness?	where is his house?
mani thzemmardh at-afedh? adhfedh	where can you find it/him/her?

5.3 Asking About Origin and Destination

Tharifith	English
Mani-s chek?	where are you from? (to a man)
Mani-s chem?	where are you from? (to a woman)
Mani-s id-yussa?	where did he come from?
Mani gha i-ruḥ?	where will he go?
Mani i-ruḥ?	where did he go?

6. Asking About Time

Questions about time are crucial for scheduling, planning, and understanding when events occur. The primary question word for time is 'mermi' (when), used to ask about specific times and dates. Additionally, there are specific constructions for asking about duration, frequency, and time of day. Understanding how to ask temporal questions will help you manage appointments, understand stories and narratives, and coordinate activities with Riffian speakers.

6.1 'When' Questions

Tharifith	English
Mermi i-ruḥ?	when did he go?
Mermi gha ad-yass?	when will he come?
mermi i-dhin thedjidh?	when were you there?
mermi ad i-khdhem?	when will he work?
Man thsaâtt dhi nha?	what time of day?
mermi gha thefdhadh?	when will you take breakfast?

6.2 Asking About Duration

Tharifith	English
Manecht n wussan/nhurath ?	how many days?
Manecht n iseggʷasen?	how many years?
Manecht n rech'hur i-yaâdhun?	how many months passed?
Manecht thedja?	how long is it/she?

6.3 Time-Related Questions in Context

Tharifith	English
mermi ad i-raḥ ghar th'hanut?	when will he go to the market?
Mermi id-yussa?	when did he come?
Mermi i-teẓriḍh?	when did you see him/her?
Man w-as/nha migedh nedja?	which day is it?
Man thsaâtt?	what time (hour)?

7. Asking About Quantity and Reason

Questions about quantity and reason allow you to gather specific information about amounts and motivations. The expression 'manecht' (how much/how many) is used to ask about quantities, while 'magha/maimmi' (why) is used to ask about reasons and causes. These questions are essential for shopping, understanding motivations, and engaging in deeper conversations about actions and decisions.

7.1 Quantity Questions

Tharifith	English
manecht?	how much? / how many?
manecht n wussan?	how many days?

Manecht/ mech’har n tharwa?	how many children?
manecht/ mech’har n ucheffai?	how much milk?
Manecht/ mech’har i-tegg?	how much is it?
Manecht/ mech’har n thudrin?	how many houses?
Manecht/ mech’har i-gharek?	how much do you have?

7.2 'Why' Questions

Tharifith	English
Maimmi/ Maghar i-ruḥ?	why did he go?
Maimmi/ Maghar ur dyussi cha/chi?	why didn't he come?
Maimmi/ Maghar i-yegga manaya?	why did he do this?
Maimmi/ Maghar tettedh?	why are you eating?
Maimmi/ Maghar ur dhin thedjidh chi/cha?	why aren't you there?
Maimmi/ Maghar i-razzu ad i-yugur/yuyar?	why does he want to go?

7.3 'How' Questions

Tharifith	English
Mokh/ mamech thedja?	how is she?
Mokh/ mamech yedja?	how is he?
Mokh/ mamech i-kheddem?	how does he work?
Mokh/ mamech gha th-iri?	how will it/she be?
Mokh/ mamech i-yedja ubridh?	how is the road?
Mokh/ mamech t-ẓareḍh?	how did you see it?

8. Indirect Questions

Indirect questions are questions embedded within another sentence, often following verbs of asking, knowing, or wondering. In Tharifith, indirect questions maintain the question word but are integrated into the larger sentence structure. These constructions are common in reported speech and in expressing uncertainty or curiosity about something. Learning to form indirect questions will allow you to express more complex thoughts and engage in more sophisticated discourse in Tharifith.

8.1 Embedded Questions

Tharifith	English
ur i-essen chi/cha mani i-ruḥ	he doesn't know where he went
ur i-essen chi/cha min i-khdhem	he doesn't know what he did
Nech tough min yaâna isem ines/nnes	I forgot what his name is

8.2 Responses with 'If/Whether'

When asking about whether something is true or not, Tharifith uses 'ma' to introduce the embedded question.

Tharifith	English
Ur i-essen chi ma yusid	he doesn't know if he came
Seqsigh ma ira thedja dhini	I asked if she was there
Ur singh chi/cha ma thedja	I don't know if it exists

9. Question Tags and Confirmation

Question tags are short questions added to the end of statements to seek confirmation or agreement. They are common in conversational Tharifith and serve to engage the listener, verify understanding, or express uncertainty. Unlike English, where question tags are formed by inverting the auxiliary verb (isn't it?, don't you?), Tharifith uses fixed expressions that can be added to statements regardless of the verb form. Learning these expressions will help you sound more natural in conversation and better understand Riffian discourse patterns.

9.1 Common Question Tags

Tharifith	English Equivalent	Usage
Dh thidhett? Nigh lla ? or Nichan nigh lla?	right? isn't it?	seeking confirmation
Mokh / mamech?	how about it?	seeking opinion
dh tta ma?	is that so?	for feminine subjects
dh wa ma?	is that so?	for male subjects

9.2 Question Tags in Context

Tharifith	English
i-ruḥ ghar ssuq, yak?	he went to market, right?
Nhara dh'azirar, nigh lla?	Today is long, isn't it?
Ur dyussi chi/cha, yak nichan?	he didn't come, is that so?

9.3 Seeking Clarification

Tharifith	English
Min tennidh?	what did you say?
Mokh/ mamech igga/thegga?	how is it?

Sfehma-yi-d!	explain to me!
âawdhasd!	say it again!
Mokh/ mamech i-das theqqaredh?	how do you say it?

10. Practice Exercises

The following exercises will help you practice forming and understanding questions in Tharifith. Work through each exercise carefully, and refer back to the lesson content as needed. Remember that practice is essential for developing fluency in asking and answering questions.

Exercise 1: Yes/No Questions

Convert the following statements into yes/no questions using intonation.

1. Anebdu-ya yaâdhu dheghya. → _____
2. i-ruḥ ad-isu atay → _____
3. Thanita dh tasrith inek/nech. → _____
4. aghrum yehma → _____
5. wanita dh'ayyaw inek/nnech. → _____

Exercise 2: Question Words

Fill in the correct question word (wi, mani, maimmi, mermi,min, mamech).

1. _____ i-ruḥ? (Where did he go?)
2. _____ thedja? (How is she?)
3. _____ dak/dach t-inna-n? (Who told you?)
4. _____ yuqâan? (What happened?)
5. _____ ur d-yusi chi/cha? (Why didn't he come?)
6. _____ gha ad-yas? (When will he come?)

Exercise 3: Translating Questions

Translate the following English questions into Tharifith.

1. What is this? _____
2. Where is the house? _____
3. Who is she? _____
4. How much bread do you have? _____

5. When did you arrive? _____

Exercise 4: Answering Questions

Provide appropriate answers to the following questions.

1. gharek aghrum ma? (Do you have bread?) _____
2. wi i-ruḥen? (Who went?) _____
3. mani thedja thaddarth? (Where is the house?) _____
4. mamech/ mokh thedjidh? (How are you?) _____
5. maimmi ur dyussi chi/cha? (Why didn't he come?) _____

Exercise 5: Question Tags

Add appropriate question tags to the following statements.

1. i-ruḥ ghar ssuq,_____? (he went to market, right?)
2. Dinni ijen temghath, _____? (there's a woman there, isn't there?)
3. ur dyussi-chi/cha _____? (he didn't come, is that so?)
4. aâchi-ya dh'azegrar/dh'azirar, _____? (this evening is so long, isn't it?)

11. Answer Key

Exercise 1: Yes/No Questions

1.
2.
3.
4.
5.

Exercise 2: Question Words

1., 2., 3., 4., 5., 6.

Exercise 3: Translating Questions

1.
2.
3.
4.
5.

Exercise 4: Answering Questions

1.
2.
3.
4.
5.

Exercise 5: Question Tags

1.
2.
3.
4.
5.

12. Lesson Summary

In this lesson, you have learned the essential structures and vocabulary for asking questions in Tharifith. Yes/no questions are formed primarily through intonation, raising the pitch at the end of a statement, though the particle 'ma' can be used for emphasis. Answers to yes/no questions include 'yeh/wah' (yes), 'lla/lawalo' (no), and more emphatic forms like 'yedja' (there is) and 'ur yedji chi/cha' (there isn't).

The interrogative words you have learned are fundamental to information-seeking in Tharifith: 'min' (what), 'mani' (where), 'wi/min' (who), 'mermi' (when), 'maghar' (why), 'mamech/mokh' (how), and 'manecht/mech'har' (how much/how many). These words typically appear at the beginning of questions and allow you to gather specific information about things, places, people, times, reasons, methods, and quantities. The ability to form questions with these words opens up countless possibilities for conversation and information gathering.

You have also learned about indirect questions, which embed questions within larger sentences, and question tags, which are used to seek confirmation or agreement. These constructions are common in natural speech and will help you sound more fluent and natural in conversation. Remember that questions are not only grammatical structures but also social tools, knowing how to ask questions appropriately demonstrates interest and engagement in Riffian culture.